- The meal should be a supplement and not a substitute to the home diet.
- The meal should supply atleast one third of the total energy requirement and half of the protein need.
- Cost of the meal should be reasonably low.
- Meal should be such that it can be prepared easily in schools. No complicated cooking process should be involved.
- As far as possible, locally available foods should be used. This will reduce the cost of the meal.
- Meal should be frequently changed to avoid monotony.

ACTIVITY

1. Download the MCP card from the website icds_wcd.nic.in. Use the card to find out the health and nutritional status of pregnant mothers, infants and preschool children in your neighbourhood.
2. Case study: 3 year old Ram weighs 13 kgs and his height is 90 cms. Find out his nutritional status in the ICDS card.
3. Visit an Anganwadi centre near your house and find out what are the benefits offered to the beneficiaries.
   (i) Food only: Yes/No
   (ii) Education only: Yes/No
   (iii) Food and Education: Yes/No

Objectives of the school feeding programme are to :

- provide food for undernourished children and to improve the nutritional status and monitor it.





Fig 12.2: Mid-Day meal programme (MDMP)

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